

**ZIA UR REHMAN BARQ,** *36*
**| SP | *Sambhal, UP***

Grandson of former Sambhal MP Shafiqur Rahman Barq who died this February, Zia's political initiation began at the Aligarh Muslim University Student's Union. He contested the 2017 assembly poll on an AIMIM ticket but won from Kundarki in the 2022 assembly poll on an SP ticket. A vocal politician, he advocated that BHU start Islamic Studies as a counter to the suggestion that Sanatan Dharma be taught at AMU. Victory was sweet, as he defeated the BJP's Parameshvar Lal Saini by more than 170,000 votes.



**TANUJ PUNIA** *39*
**| CONGRESS |**
***Barabanki (SC), UP***

His father P.L. Punia was the Dalit face of the Congress and represented the seat in 2009. Tanuj, an engineer from IIT Roorkee and general secretary and spokesperson, UPCC, made several electoral forays—the 2017 and 2022 state polls, the 2019 Lok Sabha election—without success. But the Congress retained faith in him, and fielded him yet again. This time, Tanuj delivered, defeating the BJP candidate, Rajrani Rawat.



**AMAR KALE,** *50*
**| NCP (SP) |**
***Wardha, Maharashtra***

The Congress had been forced to concede this stronghold to NCP (Sharadchandra Pawar), but when it was time to field a candidate, the latter had no option but to fall back on a legacy Congressman–former MLA Amar Kale. Son of four-time ex-MLA Sharadrao Kale, Amar is also former home minister Anil Deshmukh's nephew. He defeated two-term BJP MP Ramdas Tadas this time, aided by anti-incumbency among farmers and rural youth, and his Kunbi community.

## THE DEBUTANTS | INHERITORS



**VISHAL PATIL,** *43*
**| IND. | *Sangli, Maharashtra***

Grandson of veteran Congressman Vasantdada Patil, Sangli had been a Congress stronghold till former Congressman Sanjaykaka Patil put a halt to its streak. It was Vishal who lost to him in 2019, and eager to avenge the humiliation. Except that the Congress ceded the seat to Shiv Sena (UBT). A miffed Vishal chose to contest independently, and won. Point made, he decided to support the Congress anyway.



**CHANDAN CHAUHAN,** *35*
**| RLD | *Bijnor, UP***

Grandfather Chaudhary Narayan Singh was the first deputy CM of UP and father Sanjay Singh has been Bijnor MP. Chandan himself has been an RLD MLA from Meerapur. The family's strong hold among the Gurjars here is what saw Chandan emerge on top in the three-cornered contest against local Jat leader, Chaudhary Vijendra Singh of the BSP, and OBC leader Deepak Singh, fielded by Team INDIA.



**KARAN BHUSHAN SINGH,** *33*
**| BJP | *Kaiserganj, UP***

Looks like the sins of the father did not visit upon son Karan as he won the constituency that his father, the six-time MP Brij Bhushan Singh, was denied a ticket for, after India's top women wrestlers accused the former Wrestling Federation president of sexual harassment. A political greenhorn, Karan managed to defeat SP's Bhagat Ram by 148,000 votes.



**RAJABHAU WAJE,** *59*
**| SS (UBT) | *Nashik, Maharashtra***

The Wajes, who hail from Sinnar in Nashik district, are a political dynasty of sorts. Rajabhau's parents were both MLAs from here; he, too, won from Sinnar in 2014 (but lost in 2019). After the Shiv Sena split, the Wajes stayed loyal to the Thackerays and were rewarded with the LS nomination. A first-mover advantage and the Mahayuti alliance denying the seat to NCP's Chhagan Bhujbal worked to Rajabhau's advantage.



**SUNIL BOSE,** *42*
**| CONGRESS |**
***Chamarajanagar (SC), Karnataka***

The son of state social welfare minister H.C. Mahadevappa, Bose lists his occupation as social service, agriculture and business. The Chamarajanagar SC reserved seat was a keenly-watched electoral contest as part of the constituency stretches into the neighbouring Mysuru district–CM Siddaramaiah's home base–making it a high-stakes battle for the latter.



**AVIMANYU SETHI,** *33*
**| BJP | *Bhadrak (SC), Odisha***

Sethi, a businessman, had tried his luck in the 2019 general polls but was defeated. This time he got the better of sitting MP Manjulata Mandal of the BJD. Avimanyu is also the son of Arjun Charan Sethi, a former BJD leader and Union minister in the Atal Bihari Vajpayee cabinet when the two parties were in alliance. The Sethis took to the BJP in 2019.

*–Avishek G. Dastidar, Kaushik Deka, Amitabh Srivastava, Amarnath K. Menon, Dhaval S. Kulkarni, Arkamoy Datta Majumdar, Prashant Srivastava, Anilesh S. Mahajan and Ajay Sukumaran*